

Charles Harless

Software Engineering Manager | Distributed Platforms | Streaming Media

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Executive Summary

Software Engineering Manager with 15+ years of experience with software development and engineering leadership for teams building highly scalable web, mobile, and streaming media platforms for millions of users at organizations including Disney, Amazon, and NBCUniversal.

- Launched **Disney Movies Anywhere**, serving **20M+ users with 99.9% uptime**
- Improved delivery including **75% backlog reduction** and **20% deployment frequency increase**
- Delivered scalable **AWS-based distributed systems** supporting high-traffic media applications
- Managed engineering teams of up to **15 engineers**, improving job satisfaction by **50%**
- Continuously expanding expertise in cloud architecture and modern AI tooling

Professional Experience

Thinking Bear Consulting

Senior Software Engineering Consultant

Jan 2024 - Present

Advise organizations including Disney and UCLA on cloud architecture, distributed systems, and process improvements

- Provide architectural guidance on cloud platforms, streaming media, and web applications
- Consult on engineering team organization, Agile development, and software delivery practices
- Publish articles on [LinkedIn](#) about engineering leadership and modern development practices

UCLA Extension

Computer Science Instructor

Aug 2023 - Present

Teach courses in Java programming, web applications, and data structures with a focus on modern software engineering practices used in industry

- Maintain a **4.7 / 5.0 instructor rating** from students
- Mentor students transitioning into professional software engineering careers
- Incorporate real-world engineering problems and architectural patterns into coursework

Brightcove

Software Engineering Manager

Jan 2023 - Jun 2023

Managed engineering teams responsible for AWS-based media applications used by more than **2,500 enterprise customers**

- Managed **2 engineering teams** totaling **15 engineers** building cloud-based media platforms
- Increased deployment frequency by **20%** through improved workflows and team processes
- Proposed architectural improvements to reduce application initial load latency by **25%**
- Conducted team evaluations and proposed improvements to team processes increasing team morale and satisfaction by **40%**
- Reduced operational backlog by **75%** in 1 month with improved prioritization and processes

Amazon

Software Development Manager

Jan 2021 - Jun 2022

Supervised engineers developing distributed services supporting the Prime Video Global Supply Chain

- Led a **7-engineer team** building AWS-based tools to manage the lifecycle of **800+ contracts**
- Constructed a data-driven prioritization framework that increased team velocity by **15%**
- Improved team morale by **50%** by implementing career development and structured feedback
- Coordinated security remediation across **2,000+ applications** with full compliance in 1 week
- Created engineering roadmap and 3-year product plan with embedded yearly operational plan

NBCUniversal

Technical Lead

Apr 2016 - Dec 2020

Oversaw development of enterprise applications including modernization of enterprise digital platforms

- Directed development of mobile and web applications used by **23,000+ global employees**
- Built internal mobile communication platform that reduced time spent on corporate tasks by **10%**
- Analyzed mobile push notifications and recommended updates that decreased opt-out rates by **20%** and increased employee engagement by **10%**

Walt Disney Company

Staff Software Engineer - Disney Studios Research

Mar 2014 - Apr 2015

Conducted research into emerging technologies for use in enterprise and media applications

- Integrated beacon technology with an animated character to guide **100+ daily visitors** through studio facilities
- Prototyped augmented-reality mobile applications using computer vision to redeem digital assets **20% faster**

Staff Software Engineer - Disney Studios Distribution

Nov 2011 - Feb 2014

Guided development of large-scale digital platforms for streaming media

- Launched **Disney Movies Anywhere** platform serving **20M+ users** with **99.9% uptime**
- Supervised a distributed team of **15 developers** building multi-platform streaming applications
- Designed scalable AWS-based services supporting web, mobile, and set-top box clients with millions of daily transactions

Senior Software Engineer - Disney Parks & Resorts

Dec 2005 - Oct 2011

Developed consumer-facing web platforms supporting theme parks and resorts

- Led engineering efforts for **12 award-winning websites** including Disney Weddings and Aulani
- Introduced LAMP architecture and development standards improving delivery timelines by **30%**

Awards & Presentations

- Awarded the Going the Extra Mile Award at NBCUniversal for contributions to corporate intranet modernization (2016)
- Presenter at Disney Developer Summit on Lights, Camera, Stream! Behind the Scenes of Disney Movies Anywhere (2014)
- Presenter at Disney Developer Summit on Content Modeling with LEGO (2013)

Education

- Master of Science - Computer Science, University of California Los Angeles
- Bachelor of Science - Computer Science, University of Alabama

Certifications

- Certified ScrumMaster & Certified Scrum Product Owner, Scrum Alliance
- Generative AI Fundamentals Certificate, Databricks
- AWS Cloud Practitioner Essentials, Amazon Web Services

Skills

- **Leadership:** Engineering Management, Team Development, Mentorship, Agile / Scrum, Roadmaps, Stakeholder Management, Resource Planning
- **Architecture:** AWS Cloud Architecture, Distributed Systems, Microservices, System Design, Scalability & Performance, CI/CD Pipelines
- **Technology:** Java, Spring, Node.js, JavaScript/TypeScript, React, REST APIs, MongoDB, MySQL, GitHub